

as a loan default will. Unfortunately, many couples lease an automobile that carries a large “balloon” payment at the end of the lease (often 30-40 percent of the total lease). Since the car is usually worn out before the lease terminates, this balloon is simply refinanced in a subsequent lease and the payments increased. The result is a lifetime lease at ever-increasing rates.

The best advice I can offer any couple considering any of these borrowing options is found in Proverbs 22:3: “The prudent sees the evil and hides himself, but the naive go on, and are punished for it.”

13 THE MONEY BAROMETER: ECONOMIC DANGER SIGNS IN MARRIAGE

There are many danger signs that a young couple needs to look for in marriage. Allowing these to build will usually result in greater problems. When I started counseling, I decided to keep a notebook of the problems I observed. I began to see a consistent pattern that many couples had fallen into. Had they just been aware of the signs early in their marriage, they could have dealt with them. Instead they tried to find ways to cope with the stress instead of resolving it. Remember what we talked about earlier? Many times what is visible are the “symptoms,” the outside indicators of spiritual problems. In other words, it’s the violation of a spiritual principle that generates the symptom that we see.

DANGER SIGN: AN INDEPENDENT SPIRIT

The number-one danger sign in a marriage is a his money/her money attitude. In our society, about 65 percent of the wives work, and that percentage is increasing steadily. This can create an independent spirit.

Karen was nearly 30 years old when she and Marty met. She had been working since she got out of high school and had advanced to assistant vice president of a large bank. A little less than a year after they met, she and Marty were married.